Statement of teaching philosophy

My teaching philosophy can be boiled down to one observation I made during my time as an undergraduate student. I was excited to go to the classes where the professor was respectful, made me feel heard and safe to participate, and provided engaging materials. I don't remember all of the details of the content in those classes, but I remember how the professors made me feel. And after that, going to class and doing the work didn't feel like a chore. By comparison, the classes where I felt disrespected by the professor, or if the class was taught by a professor who didn't really want to be there, were painful to get through.

This is why I design my classes above all else to be respectful of the students, engaging and at times fun. I had the opportunity to teach a class on monetary policy in Spring 2026, for 85 students. One of the assignments I gave during this class was to have a 2-minute conversation with me. It could be about anything, and the goal was to help me learn their names and to break down some barriers with speaking to an instructor. I understand that students can be anxious about speaking to an authority figure, and so I wanted to provide a low stakes opportunity to practice this, with the hope that when they do have a question on the content, they would be more likely to ask. This is just one of the ways I establish a form of respect between the students and myself. Another way is to consistently ask for participation during the class. I typically ask relatively easy questions, to build confidence for the students as well as indicate to them that this is the type of question they really should know off the top of their head.

Another way I build engagement in the class is through in class activities. Throughout the monetary policy course, I developed (and borrowed) several activities to illustrate the course material. One such activity that I developed included breaking the students into small groups and assigning them roles as pretend members of the FOMC. One group member was the chair, who wanted to achieve consensus among the group, another was a hawk who wanted to fight inflation, and another was a dove who wanted to keep employment steady. The committee had an overall goal of achieving the dual mandate, but their individual incentives were different. I then simulated a series of shocks, and decisions on interest rate cuts or hikes influenced the state of the economy in the next round. The feedback I got from the students after activities like these was overwhelmingly positive, confirming my hypothesis that provided engaging materials and making the students feel like they were having fun while learning was a conducive way to operate the class.

In addition to teaching monetary policy in Spring 2026, I've taught introduction to microeconomics in winter 2024 to nine students. My course evaluations were strong, with an average score of 4.74 out of 5. Then as a teaching assistant, I've had the opportunity to lead discussion sections of Econ 101 and Econ 103 in Spring 2023, Fall 2024, Spring 2025 (head TA), and Fall 2025 (head TA). I've also had the opportunity to lead discussion sections for graduate level Macro Theory I in Fall 2023 and Fall 2025, as well as Macro Theory II in Spring 2024. I would be comfortable teaching introduction classes, intermediate classes, or graduate level classes. Additionally, I would welcome the experience of teaching field classes, either at the undergraduate or graduate level, perhaps a macro methods class or energy economics class.

In addition to teaching formally in a classroom setting, I would welcome experiences advising on research projects for graduate students. My graduate program is relatively small, and so within my cohort and between cohorts we have established a practice of helping each other and providing feedback on research projects.